for WikiLeaks, an interesting offer because that meant it would have political protection by being under the custody of the Pirate Party. Another night, after an awards party, I met up with W—— and went back with her to her house in Enkopping, which is about fifty miles outside Stockholm. My behaviour sounds cold, and no doubt was, which is a failing of mine, but not a crime. I'd spent long enough at A——'s and could see that it would be a bad idea to stay longer. Remember, I was feeling especially paranoid: I didn't like being in one place for too long and the affair with A —— was becoming public, which appeared to be something she wanted.

The thing with W—— was going nowhere, either. She was a little vague, but the night in Enkopping was fun and I thought we'd had a perfectly nice time, albeit one that probably wouldn't be repeated. She didn't seem too fussed herself, as we had breakfast together the next morning and then rode together on her bicycle to the railway station. She kindly paid my ticket – my bank card was still on the blink, though I'm always skint – and she kissed me goodbye and asked me to call her from the train. I didn't do that, and it has already turned out to be the most expensive call I didn't make. I went on to a meeting at the Journalists Union, to see about getting membership: remember, despite all my shenanigans, I was in Stockholm in an attempt to shore up various legal protections that would allow WikiLeaks to conduct its business from there, and, with any luck, for me to live without fear of being extradited to the United States.

As I said, I wasn't really using the phones. (I always carry several at once.) At one point, I did have a short conversation with W——, when she called me, but the phone was low on charge and it ran out while we were still talking. The international situation had me in its grip, and although I had spent time with these women, I wasn't paying enough attention to them, or ringing them back, or able to step out of the zone that came down with all these threats and statements against me in America. One of my mistakes was to expect them to understand this: they knew, because we'd talked about it over the week, that there were said to be 120 people working against WikiLeaks in the Pentagon. So I wasn't a reliable boyfriend, or even a very courteous sleeping partner, and this began to figure. Unless, of course, the agenda had been rigged from the start.

One of the nights I was staying with A——, she didn't come home and said she had slept with a journalist who was writing a piece about me. This was odd, I thought, and who was this guy? But I hadn't exactly been Mr